



SEBASTIAN SUESS helps repair smoke damage Wednesday at Altadena’s Woodbury Preschool Village, which he had attended as a child. Photographs by GENARO MOLINA Los Angeles Times

Parents struggle to find child care



WOODBURY founder Danielle Svihovec, left, hugs teacher assistant Natali Alvarado during cleanup.

Providers are scarce as fires close 300 facilities, threatening to further destabilize shaky sector

BY KATE SEQUEIRA AND JENNY GOLD

Hundreds of child-care providers affected by the L.A. County fires have been forced to shut their facilities and dozens of sites were destroyed, leaving scores of working families scrambling for care and dealing a blow to an already fragile sector in the region. As of Thursday, 37 child-

care facilities were reported destroyed in the fires; 21 were child-care centers, and 16 were family child-care homes. An additional 284 were nonoperational because of ash, debris, power outages or a lack of potable water, according the California Department of Social Services. Day-care owners, teachers and parents at many closed facilities near Pacific Palisades and Altadena are working to reopen. Some have hired professional remediation firms while others are throwing out damaged toys and furniture, scrubbing walls and hosing down playground equipment themselves in the hopes of being able to welcome children back. But given the extent of the damage, it’s unclear when these facilities will reopen. The state licensing de-

[See Child care, A9]

A thorny topic in rush to rebuild

Amid calls for swift restoration, some say the priorities should be fire resistance and multifamily homes.

BY DOUG SMITH

Even as the wildfires still raged, the impulse to quickly restore two devastated communities to what they once were became a political imperative. First Gov. Gavin Newsom, then Los Angeles Mayor Karen Bass, issued orders designed to speed the rebuilding of damaged and destroyed homes by stripping

away bureaucratic and regulatory obstacles. As urgent as that show of determination felt to many, it has critics among architects, urban planners and academics who would rather see public officials slow down and think deliberately about how to make the communities more resistant to fires — and contribute more to the region’s affordable housing needs. “If we just build back the way it was, it’s definitely a missed opportunity,” said Liz Falletta, an architect and professor in the USC Sol Price School of Public Policy. “It’s a missed opportunity to think differently about these things.” [See Rebuilding, A8]

Painful road for those whose homes survived

BY JACK DOLAN

At first glance, Jessica Allen is among the extremely lucky. Most of the houses on her street in Pacific Palisades came through the fire intact, while everything around their “little bubble” burned to the ground. She’s relieved her house was spared, as anyone would be, but she’s also grieving for friends who lost everything.

And she’s deeply conflicted about what comes next. By late last week, an insurance adjuster had toured her house and told her not to sign a long-term lease to live anywhere else; she and her family could be back home in three to six months, he said. The news left Allen gasping in disbelief, given the state of the surroundings. “It’s complete devastation,” she said. “My best friend’s house is gone; her husband’s [See Survivors, A9]



DANNY ROBINSON, 63, who lost his Altadena home in the Eaton fire, returns to inspect the remains of his dream car, right, a 1986 Corvette. ALLEN J. SCHABEN Los Angeles Times

FIRE TOOK HIS HOUSE — AND DREAM CORVETTE

Danny Robinson can rebuild in Altadena, but the jewel of his car collection is gone forever

BY JEFFREY FLEISHMAN

She was sleek as night wind, painted red, with a peanut-butter interior, a tuned-port motor with a factory four-speed. Oh, man, said Danny Robinson, the things that 1986 Corvette might have done. He had been working on her for a while, ordered an ignition switch and was awaiting registration. She was a wrench-turn away from being road ready, and Robinson, a well-known tinkerer on Harriet Street in Altadena, could imagine himself behind the wheel, racing beneath the evening crows that flew westward above the San Gabriels.

“That was my dream car,” he said. “It’s gone.” The wildfire that swept out of Eaton Canyon this month was terrifying, swift and fierce. It took Robinson’s home. Took his 1966 Pontiac GTO. Took the 1962 Impala. Ravaged his father’s old Ford pickup, driven up from Mississippi and preserved to remind the family of the patriarch who, more than half a century ago, brought his wife, sons and daughter out of the Jim Crow South to the California foothills. But nothing hurt like losing the Corvette, its tires melted, windshield [See Dream, A12]

COLOMBIA PUNISHED OVER ITS DEPORTEE REFUSAL

Trump orders tariff after two planes with ousted migrants from U.S. are turned away.

BY TRACY WILKINSON

WASHINGTON — Facing another early challenge to his immigration policies, President Trump on Sunday ordered a 25% tariff on exports from Colombia and a travel ban on Colombian officials and “their supporters” as punishment for the country’s refusal to accept military deportation flights from the U.S. “These measures are just the beginning,” Trump declared on social media.

Colombia’s action came as numerous countries in Latin America are attempting to figure out how to deal with the week-old Trump administration, pledging cooperation on some immigration issues but also seeking fair treatment and respect for their own national sovereignty.

Media reports in the U.S. quoted Pentagon officials as saying Mexico also denied landing permission to a deportation flight late last week. While Mexico did not explicitly confirm or deny the action, its Foreign Ministry emphasized its spirit of continued cooperation with the U.S. President Claudia Sheinbaum said she would address the matter Monday.

Nevertheless, tensions are high in Mexico, the country that is the largest source of U.S.-bound migrants and where tens of thousands are becoming stranded as Trump ends amnesty and other legal-entry programs.

Both Colombia and Mexico in the past accepted some deportation flights but may be reacting now to Trump’s threats to increase the number exponentially and include more third-country migrants. Some in the region are also unnerved by the switch from civilian aircraft to U.S. military planes in the deportations. Trump said he would raise the tariffs on all Colombian goods coming to the U.S. to 50% after one week if [See Colombia, A12]

Exit from WHO worries officials

Trump order has researchers wondering how U.S. would handle a potential bird flu pandemic. **NATION, A5**

Empty towers shift to housing

Some downtown landlords seek out renters instead of waiting for office workers to return. **BUSINESS, A10**

Rain raises risk of debris flows

Flood watch begins early in burned areas and will last through Monday afternoon. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather A shower or two. L.A. Basin: 61/41. **B5**

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